



NESR AI Hackathon

Guardrails and Recommended Tools

A quick reference for every team before you start building - what's off-limits, and where to build it. Bring questions to your hackathon lead if anything here is unclear.

Guardrails - Rules That Cannot Be Crossed

Money and Accounts

- Free tier only - no paid plans, no subscriptions, no credit card entry anywhere.
- No expense reimbursements will be processed for hackathon tool use.
- Sign up for every tool using your NESR email, not a personal email - accounts must stay company-owned and auditable after the event.

Data and Security

- No real customer, employee, financial, or operational data in any prototype - use synthetic, sample, or mock data only.
- Never upload confidential or proprietary NESR documents, code, or data to a public AI tool that trains on user input.
- No connecting prototypes to live production systems, databases, or NESR internal networks.
- No installing anything on a NESR-managed device without IT approval - browser-based or no-code tools only unless cleared.

IP and Compliance

- No plagiarized or unlicensed copyrighted content (images, text, code) in submissions.
- Don't push any NESR code or data to public repositories.
- Flag any responsible-AI, legal, or privacy concern in your submission's deliverables - this maps directly to the "Responsible AI, Legal & Compliance" judging category.

Conduct

- Solutions must be built during the hackathon window - no pre-built projects submitted as new work.
- Every team member needs an NESR email on file to register.

Recommended Tools (Free Tier)

Microsoft options are listed first in each category since NESR already has enterprise access to most of them - check with IT before creating a new external account.

AI Assistants

- ★ **Microsoft Copilot** - <https://copilot.microsoft.com> (**top pick**) - check if already enterprise-licensed for your NESR account
- **Claude** - <https://claude.ai> - Anthropic
- **ChatGPT** - <https://chatgpt.com> - OpenAI
- **Gemini** - <https://gemini.google.com> - Google

No-Code Automation and Apps

- ★ **Microsoft Power Automate** - <https://make.powerautomate.com> (**top pick**) - workflow automation
- ★ **Microsoft Power Apps** - <https://make.powerapps.com> (**top pick**) - build apps without code
- **n8n** - <https://n8n.io> - NESR already runs an instance - ask IT about workspace access instead of a new account
- **Zapier** - <https://zapier.com>
- **Make** - <https://www.make.com>

Copilot and Chatbot Builders

- ★ **Microsoft Copilot Studio** - <https://copilotstudio.microsoft.com> (**top pick**) - build a custom copilot/agent
- **Voiceflow** - <https://www.voiceflow.com>
- **Botpress** - <https://botpress.com>

Data and Analytics

- ★ **Microsoft Power BI** - <https://powerbi.microsoft.com> (**top pick**) - dashboards and analysis
- ★ **Microsoft Excel + Copilot** - <https://www.microsoft.com/microsoft-365/excel> (**top pick**) - built into your existing M365 license

Design and Prototyping

- ★ **Microsoft Designer** - <https://designer.microsoft.com> (**top pick**) - AI-assisted design

- **Figma** - <https://www.figma.com>
- **Canva** - <https://www.canva.com>

Code and Hosting

- ★ **GitHub** - <https://github.com> (**top pick**) - Microsoft-owned - public repos only for non-NESR code, never NESR IP
- **Replit** - <https://replit.com> - browser-based, no local install needed